Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 31 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Mostly clear	Fog	Partly cloudy	Light drizzle
15° 10°	13° 8°	13° 8°	15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Andy Burnham, the Mayor of Greater Manchester, has declared that 'no nation will be left behind' after meeting with First Ministers in Glasgow.**

The gathering brought together representatives from the UK's four nations to discuss the devolution of more powers to regions and cities. It signals a push for greater regional autonomy across the country.

POLITICS · UK

2 **Despite the wettest week in two years across parts of the UK, it still hasn't been enough rain to lift the country out of drought conditions.**

While October saw above-average rainfall, reservoirs across England remain very low. Much of the country is still officially in drought, highlighting ongoing water supply concerns.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

3 **A County Down man is among three individuals who have been jailed for planning a mosque attack.**

The three men pleaded guilty to attempting to engage in terrorist activity in November 2025. This significant case highlights ongoing efforts to combat extremism.

CRIME · UK

4 **The Treasury has accepted its role in the death of a staff member, following concerns raised by a Surrey coroner.**

The coroner highlighted issues with HM Treasury procedures after the death of Chloe Moffat. This raises serious questions about workplace welfare and support within government departments.

WORKPLACE · UK

5 **The government is facing pressure over defence spending, with ministers denying they are 'kicking the can down the road'.**

As plans to boost UK defence firms are unveiled, the government is being urged to set out a clear path for increased defence investment. It's a hot topic given current global events.

DEFENCE · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Fans of the hit show 'The Traitors' will be thrilled to hear former players are talking tactics and predicting the celebrity final.**

Ahead of Friday's grand finale, previous contestants are sharing their insights on life in the castle and who they think will triumph. It's all building to a dramatic conclusion!

ON AIR — Who do you think will be crowned the ultimate Traitor or Faithful tonight?

TV · TONIGHT

2 **Fortnite-maker Epic Games has confirmed a 'huge pivot' towards using Artificial Intelligence in their future projects.**

The US firm's boss addressed critics, stating that the industry needs to move forward with new technologies. This could signal a big change for how video games are developed.

ON AIR — How do you feel about AI playing a bigger role in the games we play?

GAMING · FUTURE

3 **The illustrator behind 'The Gruffalo', Axel Scheffler, is considering legal action against AI firms.**

He believes companies are breaching copyright by reproducing his distinctive work in AI-generated images. This highlights growing concerns about intellectual property in the age of AI.

ON AIR — Should AI companies be allowed to use existing artwork to train their systems without permission?

ART · FUTURE

4 **Former 'Top Gear' host Richard Hammond is embracing a 'brave' new Welsh life, enjoying wild swimming and running.**

The presenter bought a 19th-century Georgian mansion near Abergavenny last November. It sounds like he's found a tranquil new chapter away from the fast lane!

ON AIR — Could you imagine swapping city life for the Welsh countryside like Richard Hammond?

TV · NOW

5 **Fans of the 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' series are putting real life on hold for the latest book release.**

Some dedicated readers are even taking the week off work to immerse themselves in the newest instalment of the popular fantasy series. That's true dedication!

ON AIR — Have you ever taken time off work or paused your life for a new book, film, or album release?

BOOKS · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Ferrari's Charles Leclerc has set the fastest time in the first practice session for the Mexico City Grand Prix.**

It's an early boost for the Ferrari team as they look to challenge at the top this weekend. All eyes will be on qualifying later today.

ON AIR — Do you think Ferrari can carry this momentum through to the race, or will Red Bull dominate again?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta has issued a strong warning to teenager Max Dowman, saying 'we are not in Disneyland'.**

Arteta stated he will hold Dowman to the same high standards as other first-team players, after the youngster received a red card against Fleetwood. It's a clear message about discipline.

ON AIR — Is Arteta right to be so tough on a young player, or should he be more forgiving?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England's Rugby League World Cup hopes are hanging by a thread despite a 34-12 victory over Papua New Guinea.**

Following an earlier loss to Tonga, England now look set to miss out on the semi-finals. It's a disappointing outcome for the team.

ON AIR — What do you think went wrong for England in this Rugby League World Cup campaign?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4 **Manchester City's Women's Champions League hopes took a hit as they conceded late to draw 1-1 with Paris St-Germain.**

Their wait for a win in this season's competition continues, making their path forward more challenging. It was a frustrating result for the team.

ON AIR — Can Manchester City still turn their Champions League campaign around, or is it looking tough?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Lewis Hamilton believes he is unlike any driver Formula 1 has ever seen, reaffirming his determination to race into his mid-forties.**

The seven-time world champion continues to push boundaries and challenge perceptions in the sport. He's clearly not ready to hang up his helmet just yet!

ON AIR — Do you agree with Lewis Hamilton that he's a unique figure in F1, and how long do you think he'll continue racing?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A heartwarming trend sees neighbours rediscovering the joy of borrowing everyday items from each other.**
   Forget online shopping; many are finding community spirit in a good old-fashioned request for a cup of sugar or a spare egg, strengthening local bonds.

2. **The humble 'cosy reading nook' is being hailed as the ultimate stress-buster in a new lifestyle report.**
   Experts suggest that carving out a dedicated, comfy spot for reading can significantly improve mental well-being and provide a much-needed escape.

3. **People are finding unexpected delight in the subtle art of 'arranging fruit bowls' for maximum visual appeal.**
   It's more than just a place to store apples; a well-composed fruit bowl is becoming a small, everyday work of art, brightening up kitchens across the country.

4. **The surprising satisfaction of 'matching socks straight out of the laundry' is trending online.**
   What was once a chore is now being celebrated as a small victory and a moment of quiet accomplishment, with many sharing their perfectly paired piles.

5. **There's a growing appreciation for the unique charm of 'listening to the rain' patter against the window.**
   Far from being a gloomy sound, many are finding the gentle rhythm of rainfall incredibly soothing and a perfect backdrop for relaxation or contemplation.

6. **The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a coin down the back of the sofa' is bringing small smiles to many faces.**
   Whether it's a few pence or a pound coin, the discovery of forgotten treasure offers a tiny, delightful surprise in the everyday.

7. **A new study reveals that the sound of 'a ticking clock' can surprisingly enhance focus for some individuals.**
   While for others it might be distracting, certain people report improved concentration when a steady, gentle tick-tock is present in their workspace.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new piece of fruit in the supermarket will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SNIFF.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: BREAKING OFF THE FIRST SQUARE 'JUST TO TASTE TEST' BEFORE PROPERLY TUCKING IN.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'kitchen drawer discoveries', don't we?**
  What's the most surprising or long-forgotten item you've ever unearthed in your kitchen drawer of doom, and did you ever find a use for it again?

- **Sometimes, the simplest things are the best, like 'finding the perfect parking spot'.**
  What's a small, everyday moment of triumph that just makes you feel brilliant, even if it's something incredibly ordinary?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Apparently, a group of squirrels is known as a 'chatter' because of their noisy nature.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest chameleon is about the size of a sunflower seed.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, allowing them to 'tap' on leaves to find the right plants for laying eggs.
- The inventor of the Pringle potato crisp can had his ashes buried in a Pringle can.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from space.
- The 'sixth' mass extinction event on Earth is currently happening, largely driven by human activities.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds, despite looking light and airy.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds, demonstrating their surprising ability to briefly take to the air.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 31 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 304 of the year, 61 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsus Rodriguez; Christian feast day: Ampliatus; Christian feast day: Begu; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1941 — Sally Kirkland, American actress (died 2025)
- 1939 — Ron Rifkin, American actor
- 1976 — Piper Perabo, American actress and producer
- 1975 — Johnny Whitworth, American actor and producer
- 1997 — Marcus Rashford, English footballer
- 1948 — Michael Kitchen, English actor and producer
- 1967 — Vanilla Ice, American rapper, television personality, and real estate investor
- 1945 — Russ Ballard, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Western Airlines Flight 2605 crashes on landing in Mexico City, killing 73 people.
- 1999 — Yachtsman Jesse Martin returns to Melbourne after 11 months of circumnavigating the world, solo, non-stop and unassisted.
- 1968 — Great Drought of 1968: Amidst a collapse of hydropower President of Chile Eduardo Frei Montalva decrees the establishment of daylight saving time.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1996 — TAM Transportes Aéreos Regionais Flight 402 crashes in São Paulo, Brazil, killing 99 people.
- 1999 — Yachtsman Jesse Martin returns to Melbourne after 11 months of circumnavigating the world, solo, non-stop and unassisted.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1956 — Suez Crisis: The United Kingdom and France begin bombing Egypt to force the reopening of the Suez Canal.
- 1963 — Indiana State Fairgrounds Coliseum gas explosion: A gas explosion at the Indiana State Fairgrounds Coliseum in Indianapolis kills 81 people and injures another 400 during an ice show.

- 1956 — Hungarian Revolution of 1956: A Revolutionary Headquarters is established in Hungary. Following Imre Nagy's announcement of October 30, banned non-Communist political parties are reformed, and the MDP is replaced by the MSZMP. József Mindszenty is released from prison. The So...

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 1 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 305 of the year, 60 days left in 2026. Today All Saints' Day, a holy day of obligation in some areas (a national holiday in many historically Catholic countries), and its related observance: Day of the Innocents, The first day of Day of the Dead or El Dia de los Muertos celebration. (Mexico, Haiti); Anniversary of the Revolution (Algeria); Chavang Kut (Mizo people of Northeast India, Bangladesh, Burma); Chhattisgarh Rajyotsava (Chhattisgarh, India). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- **1959 — Susanna Clarke, English author and educator**
- **1979 — Alex Prager, American photographer and director**
- **1963 — Big Kenny, American singer-songwriter and guitarist**
- **1949 — Jeannie Berlin, American actress**
- **1955 — Beth Leavel, American actress and singer**
- **1958 — Mark Austin, English journalist**
- **1972 — Jenny McCarthy, American actress and model**
- **1941 — John Pullin, English rugby player (died 2021)**

THE DAY TOMORROW

- **2009 — An Ilyushin Il-76 crashes near the Mir mine after takeoff from Mirny Airport in Yakutia, killing all 11 aboard.**
- **1979 — Griselda Álvarez becomes the first female governor of a state of Mexico.**
- **1976 — Burundian president Michel Micombero is deposed in a bloodless military coup d'état by deputy Jean-Baptiste Bagaza.**

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- **2012 — A fuel tank truck crashes and explodes in the Saudi Arabian capital Riyadh, killing 26 people and injuring 135.**
- **1981 — Antigua and Barbuda gains independence from the United Kingdom.**

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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